

First Aid and Medical Emergencies

Cardiac Arrest

Signs: unresponsive, not breathing or only gasping, no pulse.

Call 112/911 immediately. Begin CPR: 30 chest compressions (hard and fast) followed by 2 rescue breaths. Repeat.

Use AED as soon as available. Turn on, follow voice instructions, deliver shock if advised.

Continue CPR until emergency services arrive or patient recovers.

Choking

Mild choking (can cough): encourage forceful coughing. Do not interfere.

Severe choking (cannot breathe, cough, or speak): Give 5 back blows between shoulder blades with heel of hand.

Then give 5 abdominal thrusts (Heimlich maneuver): stand behind person, make fist above navel, thrust inward and upward.

Alternate back blows and abdominal thrusts. Call 112 if object not dislodged.

For infants: use 5 back blows and 5 chest thrusts. Never do abdominal thrusts on infants.

Severe Bleeding

Apply direct firm pressure to the wound with a clean cloth or bandage.

Do not remove the cloth if it soaks through — add more on top.

Elevate the injured limb above heart level if possible.

For limb bleeding that cannot be controlled: apply a tourniquet 5-7 cm above the wound. Note the time.

Call 112. Keep patient warm and calm. Do not give food or water.

Severe Allergic Reaction (Anaphylaxis)

Signs: hives, facial swelling, throat swelling, difficulty breathing, drop in blood pressure, loss of consciousness.

Give epinephrine (adrenaline) auto-injector (EpiPen) into outer thigh immediately if available.

Call 112 immediately even if symptoms improve after EpiPen. Effects are temporary.

Lay patient flat with legs elevated (unless breathing difficulty, then sit up).

Second EpiPen dose can be given after 5-15 minutes if no improvement.

Burns

Cool the burn with cool (not cold/icy) running water for 20 minutes. Do not use ice, butter, or toothpaste.

Cover with a clean non-fluffy material (cling film or clean plastic bag).

Call 112 for: burns larger than palm of hand, deep burns, burns on face/hands/genitals, inhalation injury.

Do not pop blisters. Remove jewelry near the burn area. Give paracetamol for pain.

Fractures and Sprains

Immobilize the injured area. Do not try to straighten a broken bone.

Apply a splint using rigid material padded with soft material. Extend splint beyond joints above and below fracture.

Apply ice pack (wrapped in cloth) to reduce swelling. Elevate if possible.

Open fractures (bone piercing skin): cover wound with clean dressing. Call 112 immediately.

Seek medical evaluation for all suspected fractures.